go back to our voters and seek another referendum on the road ahead,' he said. The idea of a 'referendum' was a unique AAP concept, designed to give a sense that the party was practising 'true democracy' by constantly talking to the citizens.

I was, as always, more cynical. 'Well, whatever you do, I don't see the need to resign when you have been in power for just a few weeks. You need to prove yourself to the people of Delhi still,' I said, more worried that a sudden resignation would mean a long evening in the studio.

Yogendra seemed in agreement. 'Yes, I agree with you. Best not to do anything in haste. That is exactly what I intend to tell Arvind.' A few minutes later, our correspondent who was covering the AAP wanted to flash the news. 'Sir, my sources inside AAP tell me that Arvind has already resigned.' I told her of my conversation with Yogendra and how the issue was still not decided. My correspondent was insistent. She would be proven right. An hour later, close to 8 p.m., Kejriwal confirmed his resignation. It was prime time on TV!

I later learnt that Kejriwal came to the party meeting and, without consulting his colleagues, went ahead and resigned before the waiting media. 'This lack of consultation bothered some of us. The high command culture had entered AAP too, where decisions were taken by an individual on a whim,' says one senior AAP member. Kejriwal denies this, insisting that the party had been taken into confidence. 'We all thought that the Jan Lokpal was part of our core belief system. We should not be sticking to a chair if we could not get it passed. It was a matter of principle for us,' he later claimed to me.

I was less sure of the principle involved in resigning over a legislation which needed oversight from the Central government. It seemed to me that Kejriwal, after just seven weeks in power, was looking for an exit strategy. The power discoms were threatening a blackout in the summer and the AAP would have to bear the brunt of public anger. A snap poll was perhaps the best way out.

Though he denies it, my view (with which many others would concur) is that Kejriwal was aware the countdown had begun for the general elections,